

Product Requirements — Notification Centre v2

Overview

The Notification Centre must be redesigned to give users full control over which alerts they receive, when they receive them, and how they are delivered. The current implementation sends all events to all users with no filtering, resulting in high opt-out rates and support volume.

Requirements

REQ-01 — Per-channel delivery preferences

Users must be able to choose a delivery channel (push, email, in-app, or none) independently for each notification category: comments, mentions, system alerts, and weekly digest. Preferences must be stored per user and respected within 5 seconds of being saved.

REQ-02 — Do-not-disturb schedule

Users must be able to define a recurring do-not-disturb window (e.g., 22:00–07:00 daily). During this window all push and email notifications are suppressed and queued. Queued notifications are delivered as a single digest at the end of the window, not individually.

REQ-03 — Unread badge count

The app icon badge and the in-app bell icon must display an accurate unread count. The count must decrement in real time as individual notifications are read. A 'mark all as read' action must clear the count immediately across all devices the user is signed in to.

REQ-04 — Admin broadcast notifications

Administrators must be able to send a broadcast notification to all users or to a named user segment. Broadcast messages must be delivered within 2 minutes of dispatch. Users cannot opt out of admin broadcasts, but the broadcast must be clearly labelled as coming from the platform, not from another user.

Non-goals

This release does not include SMS delivery, third-party notification aggregators, or notification analytics dashboards. These are deferred to v3.

Acceptance

All four requirements must pass QA review on staging before release. Performance: preference save-to-effect latency under 5 seconds at p99. Accessibility: notification UI must meet WCAG 2.1 AA.